

January

16

2006

Africa's first female president

When Ellen Johnson Sirleaf was sworn in as the new president of Liberia, she became the first woman to be elected head of state of an African country.



Also on this day

1913 Indian mathematician Srinivasa Ramanujan wrote to Cambridge University in the UK outlining his solutions to many maths problems, some of which remained unsolved by experts at the time. He was invited to Cambridge, where he made important contributions to mathematics.

1979 The shah of Iran, Mohammad Pahlavi, was forced into exile after protests and violent demonstrations by Islamic rebels.

1547

Ivan the Terrible

Teenager Ivan IV was crowned the first tsar of Russia. He ruled through terror and was prone to murderous rages, becoming known as Ivan the Terrible.



Born this day

1932 Dian Fossey, US conservationist. She spent two decades in the forests of Rwanda studying mountain gorillas, and later wrote the book *Gorillas in the Mist* about her experiences.

378 CE

Tikal takeover

According to records etched in stone, a warrior named Siyaj K'ak' ("Fire is born") marched into the Mayan city of Tikal (now in modern-day Guatemala). The ruler Chak Tok Ich'aak ("Jaguar Paw") died the very same day and Siyaj K'ak' took charge.

